

Guidance to deliver trainings on PSEA

Objectives of training on PSEA

Learning activities on PSEA, whether they are full trainings, 'refreshers' or shorter awareness sessions focusing on a specific aspect of PSEA work, are a critical part of empowering aid workers to actively prevent and respond to sexual exploitation and abuse.

At a minimum, PSEA trainings should ensure that participants are able to:

- Define SEA and recognise it when it occurs, in its wide variety of forms
- Understand PSEA not only as a Code of Conduct but more importantly as a set of norms, attitudes, beliefs and values nurtured within the organisation.
- Recall acceptable and unacceptable behaviour for aid workers and behave accordingly (do not commit any form of SEA themselves)
- Empathise with victims and remember to put their needs first
- Describe their role and responsibilities for prevention and mitigating the risk of SEA, as well as options for action when sexual misconduct occurs
- Communicate to others on the importance of PSEA and core principles, encourage dialogue and open discussion
- Foster the creation of an enabling environment where staff feels safe to bring up PSEA related matters, thereby encouraging dialogue, open discussion, and reporting of any concerns or suspicions of SEA via the correct reporting channels

All actors involved in providing aid should receive training on PSEA. PSEA is a cross-cutting issue, and training should be provided for staff in all functions and levels of seniority.

Training and awareness-raising sessions for personnel must be conducted both during induction **AND** on a regular basis, ideally in person, at least once a year.

Essential aspects of PSEA trainings

- **Establish a safe learning environment,** as the SEA subject is extremely sensitive especially in certain contexts, and training may trigger difficult thoughts and emotions among the participants. Some discomfort is to be expected and an important part of self-reflection. Be aware of what aspects are more sensitive in your context, and adapt training materials accordingly.
- **Ensure training takes place in a respectful, safe and positive environment** conducive to effective learning outcomes. Set ground rules at the start of the training, and ensure as a facilitator that you remain neutral and non-judgemental.
- **Include core content**, such as 1) a clear definition of SEA (that is aligned with the UN's definition); 2) a clear prohibition of SEA and statement of the zero tolerance policy; 3) a presentation of organization's reporting and feedback channels for staff and affected population and whistleblower protection measures 4) a briefing on the requirement to orient/refer victims for assistance, and importance of putting the victims needs first (how to be 'victim-centered')
- **Offer in-person, highly interactive trainings** to ensure that personnel retain the information and are able to apply it in practice. Training sessions should include discussions, group work, practical examples, visual materials such as videos, scenarios and case studies, to ensure participants fully understand and integrate PSEA in their daily work and the actions they are required to take should they receive a SEA allegation. The tendency to provide compliance heavy, policy focused, lecture-style 1-2h briefings have proven to be ineffective in reaching desired objectives for PSEA.
- **Avoid merely prescriptive trainings**: training and awareness-raising sessions on PSEA should be taken as opportunities for personnel to exchange and discuss on topics that are likely deemed sensitive, to commonly agree on attitude and behaviours that will be expected within the organisation.
- **Use training as opportunities to strengthen overall organisational PSEA capacities**: PSEA is a multi-functional responsibility, and it may be helpful to your organisation to use these PSEA training sessions as platform between members of personnel to reflect on current PSEA systems, reflect on additional needs and strategies, to build organisation-wide ownership. For example, you may integrate in your PSEA training a group discussion/work or brainstorming sessions to develop additional reporting channels and mechanisms, and for colleagues in different functional roles to agree on what actions they can take to mitigate the risks of SEA in their functional area (e.g. HR, Operations, implementation of project activities)
- **Adapt training content to the audience** by describing their PSEA-specific roles and responsibilities and presenting examples of SEA that participants might encounter in their everyday work. Ensure the scenarios and case studies are adapted to the local context. SEA must be understood as a daily reality, rather than a far stretch issue.
- **Discuss the impacts** (short, mid and long term) of SEA, both on the victim, the community and the organisation
- **Increase accountability** by requiring participants to acknowledge in writing their responsibilities for complying with the code of conduct and the consequences for breaching it.
- **Offer regular refresher trainings** to ensure that personnel are aware of the latest policies

and procedures on PSEA[1] and how that reflects on their corresponding roles and responsibilities

Core elements of PSEA training

PSEA trainings and sessions with the organisation's personnel must include at minimum, the following elements:

- ⬜ A clear definition of SEA (same as or substantively similar to the UN's definition), illustrated by examples.
- ⬜ An explicit prohibition of SEA, through the zero-tolerance policy of the organisation
- ⬜ The PSEA-related obligations of personnel, including without being limited to: obligation to refrain from committing SEA, obligation to promptly report any known or suspected allegations of SEA, and requirement to participate in good faith in any investigation or audit related to a SEA allegation.
- ⬜ The presentation of whistleblower protection measures to avoid any retaliation following the reporting of an allegation.
- ⬜ The presentation of available reporting and feedback channels accessible to staff and beneficiaries. This can include the sharing of contact details of any PSEA focal points if appointed.
- ⬜ The requirement that alleged victims of SEA shall be referred for immediate, professional assistance, and how to provide a victim-centered response following a disclosure of SEA.
- ⬜ Clear examples of prevention activities to mitigate the risks of SEA in project activities

It is recommended that PSEA trainings and sessions include the following elements as well:

- ⬜ Sharing of values of the organisation, based on respect of all people's rights and dignity, fight against injustice, violence and abuse of power.
- ⬜ Discussion on impacts (short, mid and long term) of SEA, both on the victim, the community and the organisation
- ⬜ Discussion on the importance of PSEA, in the context of the organisation.

Examples to integrate group discussions and work in PSEA trainings

Saying no to Sexual Misconduct learning package

The 'Saying No to Sexual Misconduct' learning package is an interactive and innovative course that aims to raise awareness among IASC partner staff and ensure they have the skills and tools to define, detect and respond to sexual misconduct.

This one-day in-person training uses case studies, testimonies, group discussions, creative team and role-play activities, powerful videos and thought-provoking questions to promote dialogue and learning.

[1] PSEA-MOS requires members to conduct annual refresher training (MOS-PSEA).

This training is intended for employees of partner organizations that collaborate with UN agencies and NGOs in providing humanitarian assistance and protection.

The package includes complete course materials including for activities and handouts, detailed facilitation instruction, and an online resource for facilitators to help them prepare.

Other examples

Although the exercises and questions below may be more adapted to group sessions, they may also be used for PSEA induction sessions with newly recruited personnel.

Getting started :

- **Question:** When you hear 'sexual exploitation and abuse', what comes to your mind ? What do you know about sexual exploitation and abuse ?

Examples of media:

No Excuse for Abuse: Preventing SEA in Humanitarian Action - Youtube video available in 58 language
PSEA: it is everyone's responsibility - youtube video available in 8 language

Why is PSEA important ?

- **Question:**
  - Why is it important to treat PSEA as a priority?
  - Why does it involve all of us?
  - What are the standards, norms, attitudes and values that we want to defend in our organisation?

- **Exercise:** split the participants in several groups (maximum of 4 people per group) and ask to reflect on:
  - the importance of PSEA
  - the importance to have prevention and response mechanisms
  - why PSEA and issues around sexual misconduct are a matter that concerns us all.
- Collect the reflections in plenary, and write them down: they may be used as 'advocacy points' or key quotes in your awareness raising efforts.



What is PSEA? Reflection on definition, concepts, scope and examples:

- **Question:** How would you define SEA?
- **Exercise 1:** provide participants with definitions, split them in several groups (maximum of 4 people per group) and ask to reflect on examples of situations of SEA. Collect the examples in plenary. Write them down, they may be used in your PSEA policy, Code of Conduct or future trainings to better illustrate definitions and anchor SEA in the daily realities of your personnel.
- **Exercice 2:** give examples of situations, and ask participants whether a situation is SEA or not. This may be done in group or in plenary.

Reflection on expected conduct and behaviour from personnel:

- **Question:** What are our obligations as individuals in relation to PSEA?
- **Exercice:** provide participants with examples of situations, and ask:
    - Whether the situation is SEA or not – justifying why
    - What they should do in this situation

Reflection on obstacles to reporting:

- **Exercise:** split participants in several groups (maximum of 4 people per group). Half of the groups will reflect on situation 1, the other half on situation 2. Group discussions should be given at least 15 minutes. Each group should present in plenary the key points they discussed.
    - **Situation 1:** Identify barriers and obstacles that may prevent a member of personnel to report an SEA incident.
    - **Situation 2 :** Identify barriers and obstacles that may prevent a community member or beneficiary to report an SEA incident, as victim, witness, or whistleblower. Consider intersecting factors, including age, gender, disability, etc.

Reflection on reporting channels:

- **Question:** Do you know where and how to report a situation of SEA that you might be aware of?
- **Exercise:** split participants in several groups (maximum of 4 people per group) and give 15 minutes to think about reporting channels/mechanisms for the organisation. Encourage them to consider the following elements:
    - Are there already reporting channels, mechanisms or systems for beneficiaries to share feedback and suggestions? These could be extended to include SEA reporting.
    - The need to have reporting possible in writing as well as in person.
    - Consider the members of personnel that are regularly in contact with beneficiaries, and/or that have a relationship of trust with the community.
    - The need to have several reporting channels/mechanisms
    - Key aspects of each type of reporting channel.

Reflection on victim assistance :

- **Question:** How would you define ‘victim-centric approach’ ?
- **Question:** What services and assistance may an SEA victim need?

- **Exercise:** split participants in several groups (maximum of 4 people per group) and ask to reflect on the concept of victim-centric approach. Give the five principles and ask to define and provide examples on how to guarantee them:
    - Respect
    - Non-discrimination
    - Security
    - Confidentiality
    - Voluntary and free consent

